SEO checklist: 50 checks

Technical basics, on-page SEO, local SEO, AI readiness and measurement. Every check has a priority and a way to verify it. Version: November 2026.

Website (URL) _____ Review date _____

Reviewed by _____ Next review _____

How to use this template

1. **Record a baseline:** non-brand clicks and customer inquiries (table at the bottom of this page).
2. **Collect access:** Search Console, GA4, Google Business Profile, CMS, robots.txt. Missing access is your first finding.
3. **Work through areas A–E in order** and mark each check OK, needs work or N/A.
4. **Describe the problem in the notes:** the URL and the specific issue, e.g. “/contact: no H1.”
5. **Set the order:** high priority first. Give every open check an owner and a deadline.
6. **Recheck** after the fixes and fill in the summary. Repeat the full list every quarter.

Statuses and priorities

- ☐ **OK** – the check passes
- ☐ **Fix** – needs work: note the URL and the problem
- ☐ **N/A** – doesn’t apply to your business; leave it out of the score

HIGH blocks visibility in Google or Maps, or blocks measurement; do it first

MEDIUM holds results back, but the site works and is visible

LOW polishes the details; do it alongside other changes

Review summary

AREA	CHECKS	OK	NEEDS WORK	N/A	OPEN HIGH-PRIORITY CHECKS
A. Technical SEO basics	10				
B. On-page SEO	14				
C. Local SEO	9				
D. AI readiness	8				
E. Measurement	9				
Total	**50**				

Baseline (check E9)

Non-brand clicks (Search Console, last month) _____

Customer inquiries (GA4 and inbox or CRM, last month) _____

Date recorded _____

A. Technical SEO basics

Whether Google can reach your pages, index them and display them well on a phone. For a deeper technical review, see the technical SEO audit checklist on ai-seo-company.pl. **10 checks**

NO.	CHECK AND HOW TO VERIFY IT	PRIORITY	STATUS	NOTES · OWNER · DEADLINE
A1	**The site runs on HTTPS, and http:// URLs redirect to https://** **How to check:** Type your address with http:// and confirm the browser lands on https:// with no warning.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
A2	**Only one version of the domain resolves (www or non-www), and the other redirects to it with a single permanent (301 or 308) redirect** **How to check:** Open both versions. They should end on the same page without a redirect chain.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
A3	**robots.txt does not block pages you want in Google** **How to check:** Open yourdomain.com/robots.txt. Look for "Disallow: /" and for rules covering your service or blog folders.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
A4	**Important pages carry no noindex tag** **How to check:** Search Console → URL Inspection on the homepage and service pages: indexing should be allowed.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
A5	**The XML sitemap lists only canonical URLs that work, and robots.txt points to it** **How to check:** Open sitemap.xml and robots.txt (the "Sitemap:" line). Remove redirects, 404s and noindexed pages from the sitemap. Only change lastmod when the content changes significantly.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
A6	**Every page has a canonical tag pointing to itself or to the preferred version, and language versions are linked with reciprocal hreflang** **How to check:** Page source (`rel="canonical"`) or the free SEO audit. Google treats canonical as a signal, not a directive, so check URL Inspection in Search Console to see which URL it chose. With several languages, each version lists itself and the others; adding x-default is recommended.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
A7	**Internal links don't point to 404 pages or pass through redirects** **How to check:** Use a crawler or the Pages report in Search Console. Fix the link at the source, not just the redirect.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
A8	**The site is easy to use on a phone: no sideways scrolling, readable text, buttons that are easy to tap** **How to check:** Open the homepage, a service page and the contact page on a phone. Submit the form end to end.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
A9	**Core Web Vitals pass: LCP of 2.5 s or less, INP of 200 ms or less, CLS of 0.1 or less** **How to check:** Search Console → Core Web Vitals (real-user data, 75th percentile of visits). Use Lighthouse to find the causes.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
A10	**URLs are short and readable: words instead of random IDs** **How to check:** Scan the URLs in your sitemap. Never change working URLs without 301 redirects.	LOW	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	

Area score: ☐ OK ____ ☐ needs work ____ ☐ N/A ____

B. On-page SEO: titles, descriptions, headings, content, links, images

Whether every key page tells Google and your customers what it's about, and whether links lead to it. **14 checks**

NO.	CHECK AND HOW TO VERIFY IT	PRIORITY	STATUS	NOTES · OWNER · DEADLINE
B1	**Every page has its own title that describes its content** **How to check:** Run a crawler or the free audit, sort the titles, and find duplicates and blanks.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
B2	**Titles lead with the most important information, don't repeat words, and put the brand at the end** **How to check:** Check your listing in Google. There's no character limit, but Google truncates titles to fit the screen, so the key phrase can't sit at the end of a long title. Our free audit flags titles over 60 characters.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
B3	**Key pages have a unique meta description that sums up the page and earns the click** **How to check:** Crawler: find empty and duplicate descriptions. Google sometimes shows a different snippet, so treat yours as a suggestion.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
B4	**Each page has one H1 that says what the page is about and includes the primary keyword** **How to check:** Use an SEO browser extension or view the source and count the h1 tags. Google doesn't require a single H1, but one clear heading keeps the page tidy.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
B5	**H2 and H3 headings split the content into sections that answer customer questions** **How to check:** Read the headings alone. Do they tell you what the page covers?	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
B6	**The content matches search intent: scope, price and process for a service, a direct answer for a question** **How to check:** Search the keyword and compare the kind of pages in the top 10 with yours. Add what they're missing: your own data, an example, a price.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
B7	**The first paragraph answers the main question directly and includes the primary keyword** **How to check:** Read only the first paragraph. Does a customer already know what you offer and where?	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
B8	**Every important page has its own primary keyword, and no two pages compete for the same one (cannibalization)** **How to check:** Map it in a sheet: one keyword → one URL. Then Search Console → Performance → filter by query → Pages tab. Several URLs on one query call for a decision.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
B9	**Content is current: prices, service names, contact details and dates** **How to check:** Review service pages and pricing. Show an "updated" date on articles.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
B10	**Every important page gets internal links from other pages (menu, body copy, footer)** **How to check:** Crawler: find pages with no incoming links or more than 3 clicks from the homepage. Add a link from a closely related page.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
B11	**Link text describes the target page ("website SEO audit," not "click here")** **How to check:** Review the links in the body copy of your key pages.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
B12	**Images have descriptive alt text that fits the page, with no keyword stuffing** **How to check:** Crawler: images without alt. Describe the image the way you would to someone who can't see it.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
B13	**Image files have descriptive names, a modern format (WebP or AVIF) and set dimensions** **How to check:** Check file names in your media library and the Lighthouse report.	LOW	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
B14	**It's clear who is behind the site: company name, contact details, author of expert content** **How to check:** Check the footer, the About page and article bylines.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	

Area score: ☐ OK ____ ☐ needs work ____ ☐ N/A ____

C. Local SEO: Google Business Profile and NAP

Whether your business is described consistently on your Google Business Profile, your website and directories. **9 checks**

NO.	CHECK AND HOW TO VERIFY IT	PRIORITY	STATUS	NOTES · OWNER · DEADLINE
C1	**The business has a verified Google Business Profile, one per location** **How to check:** Search your business name in Google and Maps. Report duplicates for removal or merging.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
C2	**The profile name is your real-world business name, with no added keywords, city or tagline** **How to check:** Compare it with your signage, invoices and website.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
C3	**The primary category says what the business is, and additional categories are kept to a minimum** **How to check:** Profile dashboard → categories. A category is a type of business, not a list of services.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
C4	**NAP (name, address, phone) is identical on your site, your profile and business directories** **How to check:** Copy the NAP from each place into one table and compare it character by character.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
C5	**A business that doesn't serve customers at its address hides the address and sets a service area** **How to check:** Profile dashboard → location and service area.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
C6	**Opening hours are current, and holidays have special hours** **How to check:** Check the profile before every long weekend and public holiday.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
C7	**The site has a contact page with the NAP as text (not an image), a map and directions** **How to check:** Try to select the address with your mouse. If you can't, it's an image. Several locations: one page each.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
C8	**Reviews come in steadily, and each one gets a reply from the business** **How to check:** Profile dashboard → reviews. Reply to critical reviews too, factually and without customer details. Never pay for reviews or offer discounts for them.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
C9	**The profile has current photos of the premises, team or work, and a complete list of services** **How to check:** Compare it with the profiles you see in the top three map results.	LOW	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	

Area score: ☐ OK ____ ☐ needs work ____ ☐ N/A ____

D. AI readiness: bot access, content and business details

Whether AI search engines can read your site and find answers on it. Google Search doesn't use llms.txt, so that file is low priority.
8 checks

NO.	CHECK AND HOW TO VERIFY IT	PRIORITY	STATUS	NOTES · OWNER · DEADLINE
D1	**robots.txt lets AI search bots in: OAI-SearchBot (ChatGPT), PerplexityBot, Claude-SearchBot** **How to check:** Open robots.txt. Look for these names and for a "User-agent: *" group with "Disallow: /". In Search Console, also check Settings → Search generative AI: your site should be included (the default).	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
D2	**Your decision on training bots (GPTBot, ClaudeBot, Google-Extended) is deliberate and written down** **How to check:** Note in the template whether you allow them. Blocking Google-Extended does not affect Google Search.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
D3	**Your firewall (WAF) or CDN doesn't block the bots that robots.txt allows** **How to check:** Check the bot protection settings at your host or CDN, and your server logs.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
D4	**Key content (offer, prices, contact) is in the HTML, not only in images or PDF files** **How to check:** Select the text on the page and view the source. Text that exists only in a graphic is hard for any crawler to read.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
D5	**Organization or LocalBusiness structured data in JSON-LD matches what's visible on the page** **How to check:** Rich Results Test or the schema.org validator. Name, address and phone as in your profile. Google doesn't require this markup for AI Overviews, but it keeps your business details consistent.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
D6	**The About page states clear facts: what you do, where and for whom** **How to check:** Read it as someone who has never heard of you. Your company description should read the same on your profile and social accounts.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
D7	**The site answers common customer questions (price, timing, process) directly and with specifics** **How to check:** List the questions customers ask on the phone and Google's autocomplete suggestions for your service. Does each one have an answer on the site? Google doesn't need text chopped into small chunks for AI: what counts is the answer itself.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
D8	**Optional: an llms.txt file at the site root with a company summary and links to key pages** **How to check:** Open yourdomain.com/llms.txt. Google Search doesn't use it, so do it after the checks above.	LOW	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	

Area score: ☐ OK ____ ☐ needs work ____ ☐ N/A ____

E. Measurement: Search Console and GA4

Whether you know how many inquiries search brings in, and whether you compare results using the same method. **9 checks**

NO.	CHECK AND HOW TO VERIFY IT	PRIORITY	STATUS	NOTES · OWNER · DEADLINE
E1	**Search Console covers the whole domain, and a company account is the owner** **How to check:** Search Console → Settings → Users and permissions. Your agency can have access, but not as the only owner.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
E2	**The sitemap is submitted in the Sitemaps report and shows no processing errors** **How to check:** Search Console → Sitemaps: status “Success” and the number of discovered URLs.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
E3	**The Pages report has been reviewed: key pages are indexed and exclusion reasons are understood** **How to check:** Search Console → Pages. Start with service and contact pages.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
E4	**GA4 runs on every page through a single tag, and the company owns the property** **How to check:** Google Tag Assistant preview or the Realtime report in GA4.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
E5	**GA4 key events track customer actions: form submissions, phone clicks and email clicks** **How to check:** GA4 → Admin → Key events. Submit a test form and check that the event shows up.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
E6	**GA4 is linked to Search Console** **How to check:** GA4 → Admin → Product links → Search Console links.	LOW	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
E7	**The keyword list you track is agreed and written down, and you measure rankings the same way every month** **How to check:** Record keywords, location and device. Changing the method breaks comparisons.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
E8	**A fixed set of customer questions is checked monthly in ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity and Google AI Overviews** **How to check:** Record the questions and the outcome: is your business named, and which sources are cited? For Google, the Generative AI performance report in Search Console shows impressions in AI Overviews and AI Mode.	MEDIUM	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	
E9	**A baseline is recorded before any changes, and results are compared year over year** **How to check:** Record the date, non-brand clicks and customer inquiries. Count inquiries in your inbox or CRM too: when visitors decline cookies, GA4 can undercount them.	HIGH	☐ OK ☐ Fix ☐ N/A	

Area score: ☐ OK ____ ☐ needs work ____ ☐ N/A ____